

**DIY AWM Rifle**

Check out this video demonstrating how to make a cardboard gun based on the AWM model. <http://digit.in/feb21-87>

**Historic Guns**

From primitive hand cannons to automatics, here are the greatest gun breakthroughs in history. <http://digit.in/feb21-88>

Gunsmiths and their guns

Bang for your buck

Here are the weapons manufacturers that came up with the firearm design and innovations, that resulted in some of the most reliable, widely used and iconic guns ever made.

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**Samuel Colt (1814-1862)**

Samuel Colt refined existing designs for an assembly line production, and came up with the first practical revolver that was mass produced. This reliable sidearm allowed early American law enforcement agencies, such as the Texas Rangers, to tame the wild west. Till then, guns could fire only a single shot, while the Colt revolver allowed a single person to fend off multiple attackers. This gun allowed American expansion into the west.



Colt Single-Action Army

**Richard Jordan Gatling (1818-1903)**

Gatling originally started inventing machines that allowed him to plant a lot of cotton seeds at once. He used the experience to come up with the Gatling gun, a hand cranked machine gun that needed two people to operate. The gun allowed a small number of US soldiers to fend off larger numbers of Indians. The design fell out of use but was revitalised by the US army for use in fighter jets, combat helicopters and battleships.



GAU-8 Avenger

**Jacob and Samuel Hawken (1825-1855)**

Shown here is Samuel Hawken the younger of two brothers, who ran a shop in Missouri making individual guns (not mass produced) for American fur trappers, frontiersmen, scouts, settlers, traders, pioneers, naturalists, hunters and army officers working in the prairies and the Rocky Mountains. Many of them would use their Hawken rifles to win fame and glory. The weapon came to be known as the "plains rifle" or the "buffalo gun".



Hawken Rifle

**Wilhelm and Paul Mauser (1834-1882)**

Wilhelm and Paul Mauser (shown here is Wilhelm, the older brother) made bolt action hunting rifles, and the design was so popular that it was copied by gun manufacturers around the world. The weapon found widespread use during World War I, and an excess of 100 million guns were made in the first half of the twentieth century. The rifles continues to be popular for sport hunting till this day, with the modern variants using better materials, but still the same fundamental design.



Mauser 18 Stainless